

HP Omen 17 (2023)

RTX 4080 + i9-13900HX = A PC killer

The new 2023 variant of the HP Omen 17 combines the powerful processing of the 13th gen Intel Core i9-13900HX with the powerhouse RTX 4080 GPU, to give us the most powerful gaming laptop we've tested to date. It's leagues ahead of gaming laptops we tested just last year. Of course, this package doesn't come cheap at a premium price of Rs 303,501, but considering the specs on board, well, even gaming desktop users might be tempted by this one.

PERFORMANCE

The HP Omen 17 is the first laptop we've tested this year featuring an RTX 4080. It's powerful enough to comfortably play the latest AAA games at QHD resolutions. While it's not the best laptop GPU NVIDIA has to offer, that would be the 4080 Ti, it handily beats our previous best-performing gaming laptop, the MSI Raider GE67HX which features a 3080Ti. Coming to real-world gaming performance, while the HP Omen 17 has the highest FPS scores in majority of the titles, it still falls slightly behind in some titles, which does come as a bit of a surprise.

Next comes the CPU, the 13th gen i9-13900HX is the fastest laptop processor we've tested to date. It shouldn't come as a surprise that it aced all of our CPU and productivity benchmarks. The Omen 17 scores the highest scores we've seen yet in a laptop in PCMark 10. The same applies to the Cinebench R23. It knocks encryption and decryption out of the park as well, with results in WinRAR and 7-zip nearly double our previous best gaming laptop. If that wasn't enough, the HP Omen 17 also features the fastest RAM we've tested to date in a gaming laptop as well. The laptop comes with 1TB of PCIe 4 NVMe SSD storage. And while it may not be the best storage we've tested, it's still very fast. The laptop comes with two

slots for storage, so you could expand storage later as well.

NOISE AND HEAT

The laptop can get very loud under stress. You can easily hear the whirring and even some whistling when the laptop is being pushed to its limits, such as during stress tests. The sound dies down significantly when the laptop is idle.

Coming to temps, the laptop ran surprisingly cool, averaging surface temps of around 29 degrees celsius under stress. The centre of the laptop was the hottest, at around 35 degrees. Clearly, the fans are doing their part, and the size of the laptop certainly helps with better airflow.

DISPLAY

Like we mentioned earlier, you've got a massive 17.3-inch display with a QHD resolution, that's 2560x1440 pixels. This is a matte IPS panel with a refresh rate of 240 Hz, and you should easily manage to actually get those frames from most games you play on this laptop. In our tests, we got a peak average brightness of 317 nits compared

to the advertised 300 nits which is good. However, we got a sRGB coverage of 95.3% which is a little less than the advertised 100%. That being said, we should point out that most high-end gaming laptop displays in this price range offer much brighter displays.

BUILD AND DESIGN

You'll immediately notice that this laptop is pretty big. You've got a metallic build with a mix of brushed and matte finishes. We found the laptop to be fairly sturdy overall, with the hinges being the exception; there's a fair bit of flex and the lid tends to wobble. The laptop's also pretty heavy at around 2.8 kg which is to be expected with all that hardware on board. You've got a nice selection of I/O port offerings as well, with the left side of the

laptop featuring a Gigabit Ethernet port, a USB-A 3.2 Gen 1 port, a Mini DisplayPort, HDMI 2.1, Thunderbolt 4, audio combo, and a storage card reader. The right side features two USB-A 3.2 Gen 1 ports.

VERDICT

The HP Omen 17 is the only high-end 40 series GPU laptop we've tested so far this year, it's got a leg up on the competition, and at the Rs 3lac price tag, it's weirdly enough affordable for the specs on offer. Of course, with more and more 40 series laptops making their way into the market, this might change, but until then, the HP Omen 17 is certainly worth checking out.

—Manish Rajesh

SPECIFICATIONS

CPU: 13th Generation Intel Core i9 processor | Windows 11 Home | Display: 43.9 cm (17.3 in) diagonal QHD display 240 Hz, 3 ms response time | NVIDIA GeForce RTX 4080 GPU | 32 GB DDR5-5600 MHz RAM | 1 TB PCIe Gen 4 NVMe SSD | Weight: 2.76 kg | Full-size, 4-zone RGB backlit, shadow black keyboard and 26-Key Rollover Anti-Ghosting Key technology

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